* After the death of Muhammad himself in 632, the leadership of the new Muslim community was claimed by the Prophet's old friend Abu Bakr, who had the support of many of Muhammad's followers. Others, though, believed that Muhammad's closest male relative, his son-in-law Ali, should be the Prophet's successor. Although Ali himself agreed to accept Abu Bakr's headship, a subset of Muslims continued to insist that only Ali and his successors were divinely appointed, and that Abu Bakr and his immediate successors were illegitimate usupers. They became known as "Shi'ite" Muslims (the "party of Ali"), while the supporters of Abu Bakr became known as "Sunni" Muslims. As Farhad Daftary points out in his study of the Isma'ili sect, the early history of the Shi'ite movement is "shrouded in obscurity," but within a century the Sunni and Shi'ite Muslims had already developed significantly different theological doctrines, traditions, and laws. The events surrounding Abu Bakr's succession are described in Bauer, *The History of the Medieval World*. pp. 295ff; Daftary's useful capsule explanation is found in chapter 2 of *The Assassin Legends: Myths of the Isma'ilis* (I. B. Tauris, 1995).